

smart enough to come up with good technologies? Now *that's* an allegation of stupidity, and we Windows folks are a little hurt.

To our disgruntlement, the reported allegations went on and on. "Microsoft has mimicked Apple by integrating an RSS reader into the browser." Like it isn't obvious that an RSS reader is a must-have these days.

Then there's the Time Machine feature in Leopard, which lets users recover documents they deleted in the past, and more. And Microsoft is planning on a similar technology called Previous Versions. And Jobs and co. will, of course, say this is a copied feature. We'd call it "inspiration", not "copying". Seriously, Mr Jobs, we can debate till kingdom come, but the fact is that someone thinks of it, and others get inspired. Did Skype "copy" Net2Phone? Did Yahoo! "copy" the "cached" feature that Google gave us? And didn't Microsoft go beyond your crappy one-button mouse?

At this point, we'll quote Robert McLaws, IT

Excuses, Excuses

If you ever met someone nuts about guns, would you upset him? We won't be getting on the wrong side of newcomer Vishal, that's for sure. His gun discussions with Michael have put many a JDM employee to sleep just by being in their vicinity!

In other news, no doubt you too have noticed all the rain this month—it's caused many of us to... er... fall ill (wink, wink) and not come to work, much to the consternation of Ed Deepak. His vocabulary of expletives has increased manifold, and his impassioned lectures are a joy to listen to, especially for third parties not being scolded.

We found ourselves an unexpected little guest this month—no, no babies, just the ridiculous yellow car Nimish bought for the bullet-time

video. At least forty people's work was disrupted as we drove it around the office under desks, between legs and jumped it off tables, ultimately smashing its headlights before the video could be shot, even! Nimish was not impressed.

And then, towards the end of the month, we had to return our much treasured Xbox 360 (temporarily, we are assured) and all hell broke loose as nearly everyone from Digit and SKOAR! cried tears of blood ("How could you take it away so close to issue-closing?"). The days following closing, as you might know, is the time we're all free to play games and generally raise hell before we begin work on the next issue, so you can imagine the disappointment.

Sometimes, we're reminded of why people tell us to "Leave this fantasy-land and get a real job!"

DIGIT DIARY

consultant and Vista enthusiast: "From what I can tell, there isn't anything in the new OS X that I can't get in Vista, and then some. I can have a Tablet and a Media Center in one computer. I can hook up my Xbox 360 to that same machine (which Mac can't do) and watch TV

recorded off my digital cable tuner (which Mac won't have). And you won't need to have Office anymore to get some basic features like spam protection and calendaring. So I get all the features and more, without the smug self-righteousness of the pseudo-intellectual Mac

zealotry. What more could you ask for in an OS?"

If Microsoft were to be as crude, they would probably write a letter to Apple that said something like, "OK, so you thought of it first, but we at Microsoft will do a better job of selling it, and we'll actually make money! Whine all you want..." ☒

Blog WATCH

Obscene videos on Google, and Apple's new Time Machine—and something about AOL and murder

Michael Arrington

<http://snipurl.com/sept01>
(<http://www.techcrunch.com/2006/08/13/google-porn/>)

Google Porn?

People watching Google Video closely noticed a change this week in the upload area—the restrictions on uploading "pornographic or obscene" material is now just a restriction on "obscene" material. They've also added a "mature and adult" category to the genres and removed (I believe) a box on the initial uploading page that must be checked where the uploader certifies that the "video is not pornographic or obscene material". This may or may not mean Google is allowing, or preparing to allow, porn. Videos containing nudity are clearly available on the site...

John Siracusa

<http://snipurl.com/v3oe>
(<http://arstechnica.com/staff/fatbits.ars/2006/8/15/4995>)

Time Machine and the future of the file system

For Mac geeks of a certain persuasion, the first mention of a soon-to-be-revealed feature of Leopard during the WWDC keynote set off a mental chain-reaction. That feature was Time Machine, and the name alone was enough to cause one particular phrase to hammer in the mind of many people, including me: "New file

system in Leopard!" It was even a bingo square. In fact, it was my personal favorite bingo square, and the one that I most looked forward to marking.

But let's back up a bit. Why should the mere name "Time Machine" scream "new file system" to anyone? And why the excitement about a new file system in the first place? What's wrong with HFS+, Mac OS X's current file system? It's got journaling. It supports arbitrarily extensible metadata. Does Mac OS X really need a new file system?

John Siracusa

<http://snipurl.com/uk0s>
(<http://plentyoffish.wordpress.com/2006/08/07/aol-search-data-shows-users-planning-to-commit-murder/>)
AOL Search Data Shows Users Planning to commit Murder

Users are pissed off at the idea that people can be arrested for planning a crime like murder, calling it minority report like. I ask you why is it that americans have no problems arresting people that are planning or researching how to conduct terrorist attacks? Yet if a person plans on killing his wife that is ok, until he actually does it? How many people do you have to plan on killing before its ok for a company like AOL to hand your records over to the government? This story will open a can of worms, and decide just how private your data online really is.